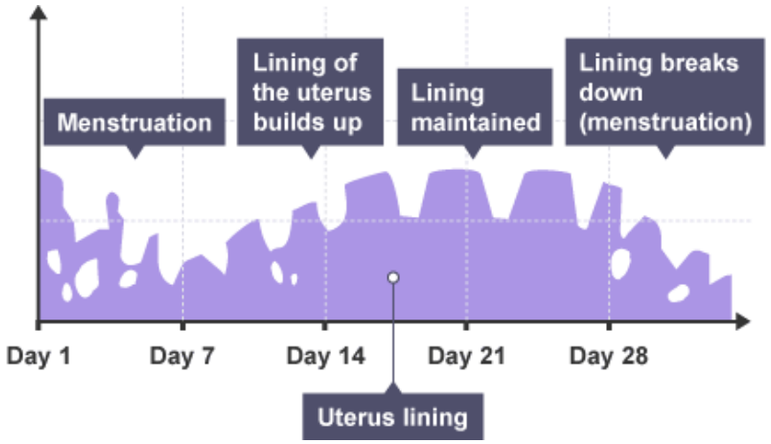
Knowledge Organiser
Year 8: Staying Alive – The Menstrual Cycle

What is the menstrual cycle?
- The **menstrual cycle** is a recurring process which takes **around 28 days**
- It begins with the **maturing of an egg** ready for fertilisation
- It ends with the shedding of the **uterus lining**, this is known as **menstruation** (a period)

What changes take place during the menstrual cycle?
- During the menstrual cycle the body is preparing itself for **fertilisation** and **pregnancy**
- The lining of the uterus thickens and is maintained, waiting for a fertilised egg cell to be **implanted**
- If no egg cell is implanted, the lining of the **uterus is shed**, which leaves the body through the vagina

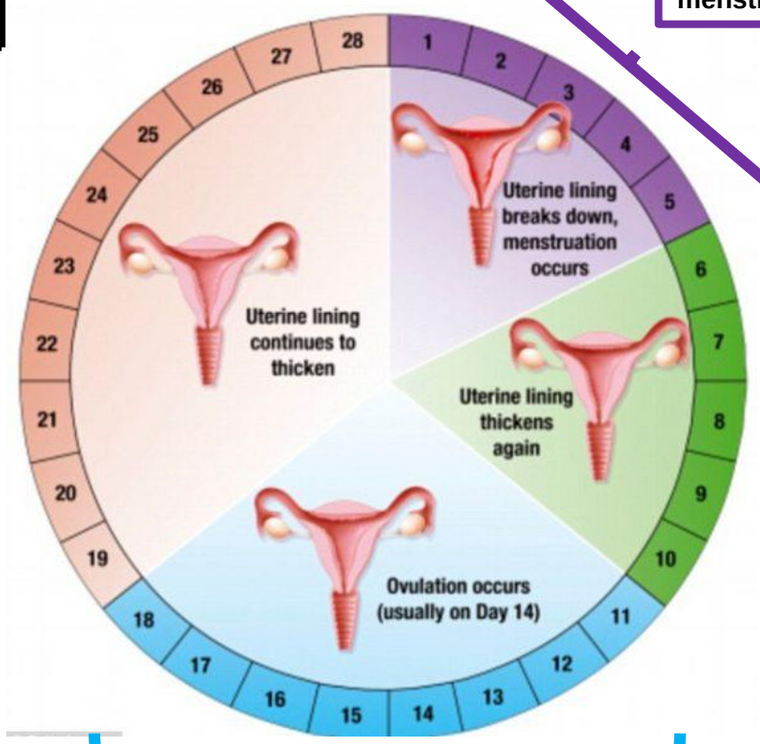
A labelled diagram showing how the lining of the uterus changes through the menstrual cycle





Most young people have their first period between 11 and 14. But many have them earlier or later

A labelled diagram showing the main stages of the menstrual cycle

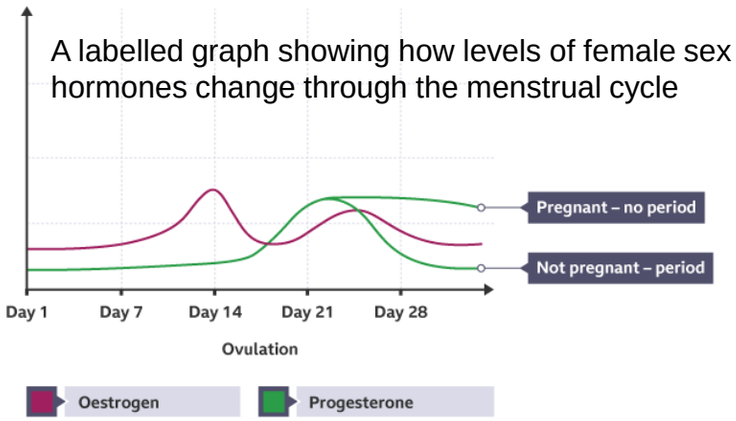


During this time the person is **menstruating,** they are "***on their period***"

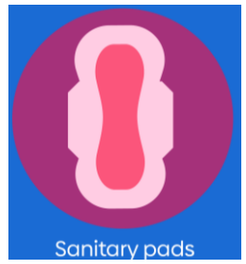
During this time the person is **ovulating**, this means they are **fertile** (able to get pregnant)

Hormones and the menstrual cycle
- Hormones are **chemical messengers** that are produced in **glands** and travel in the blood
- Two key hormones regulate the menstrual cycle
- These hormones signal the uterus lining to thicken, there is an increase just before **ovulation**
- The levels of these hormones change throughout the menstrual cycle

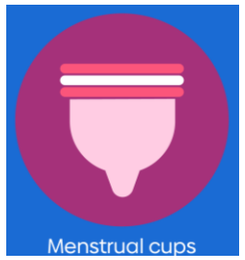
A labelled graph showing how levels of female sex hormones change through the menstrual cycle



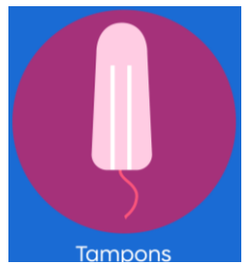
Period products – Preparing for your period
- When you get your period, you'll need to use something to soak up the **menstrual blood**
- There are lots of different products, it may take some experimenting to find what works best for you



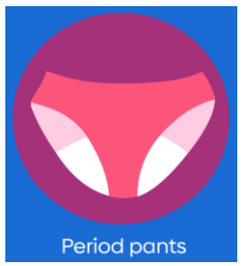
Soft layer that lines the underwear and absorbs menstrual blood



Flexible cup that is inserted into the vagina and collects menstrual blood



Soft cylinder that is Inserted into the vagina and absorbs menstrual blood



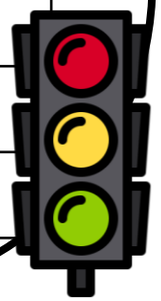
Reusable pants made from absorbent, leak proof fabric that traps menstrual blood

The menstrual cycle doesn't happen like clock work and can be unpredictable. An entire cycle usually lasts between 24 and 38 days



RAG Yourself!

Learning Outcomes;	RAG
Describe the main stages of the menstrual cycle	
Explain what ovulation is and why it is important to know about if you want to get pregnant	
Describe how the thickness of the uterus lining changes throughout the menstrual cycle	
Describe how levels of hormones change throughout the menstrual cycle	
Give examples of period products and how they work	



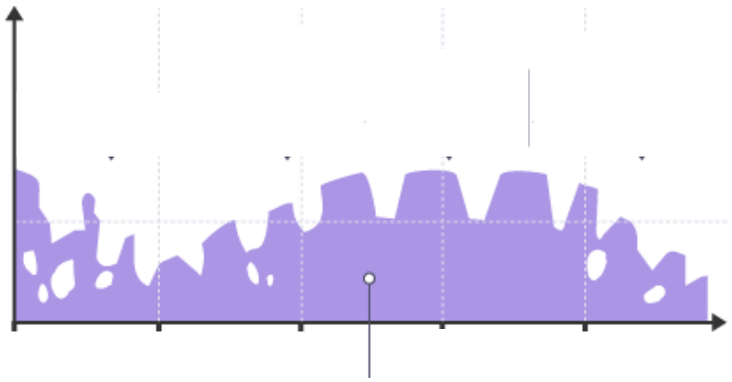
St. Crispin's
Excellence for all

Knowledge Organiser
Year 8: Staying Alive – The Menstrual Cycle

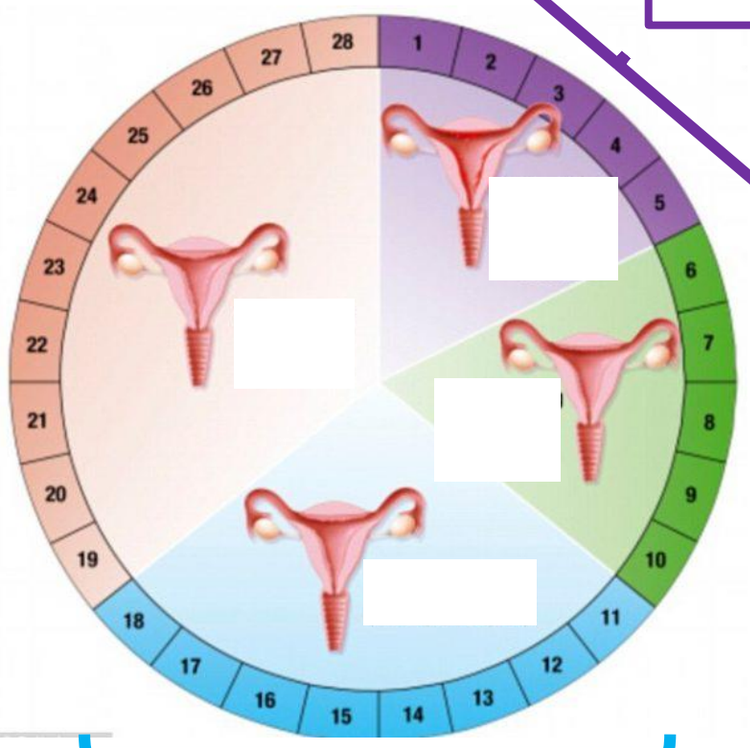
What is the menstrual cycle?

What changes take place during the menstrual cycle?

A labelled diagram showing how the lining of the uterus changes through the menstrual cycle



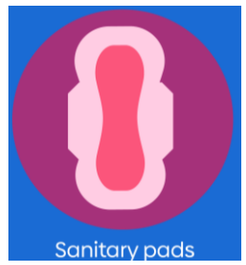
A labelled diagram showing the main stages of the menstrual cycle

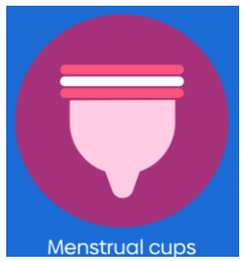


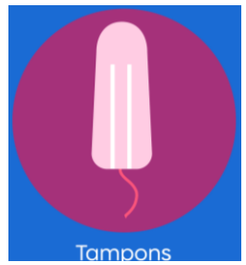
Hormones and the menstrual cycle

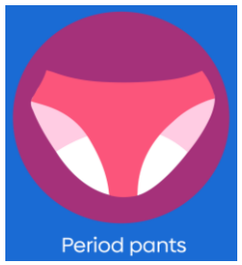
A labelled graph showing how levels of female sex hormones change through the menstrual cycle

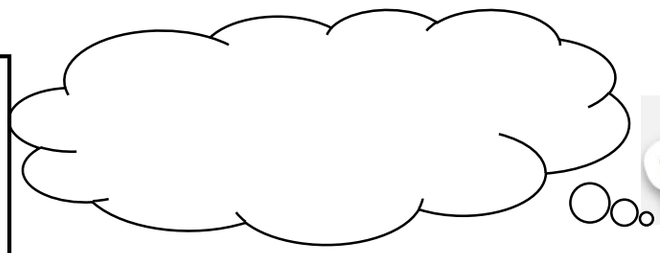
Period products – Preparing for your period





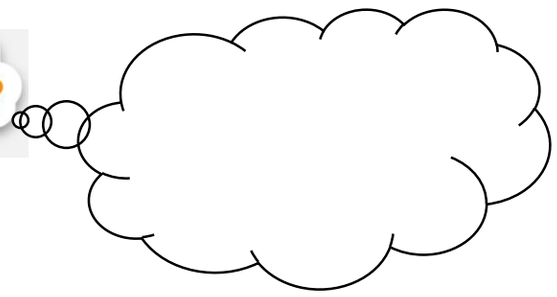






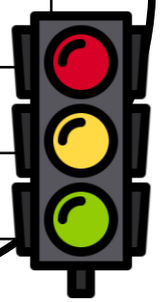






RAG Yourself!

Learning Outcomes;	RAG
Describe the main stages of the menstrual cycle	
Explain what ovulation is and why it is important to know about if you want to get pregnant	
Describe how the thickness of the uterus lining changes throughout the menstrual cycle	
Describe how levels of hormones change throughout the menstrual cycle	
Give examples of period products and how they work	



St. Crispin's
Excellence for all